FOR SLPS THINKING ABOUT LEAVING

Am I abandoning my patients if I leave?

What ASHA actually says, and how to leave a caseload well.

Swipe →

“I have such guilt for leaving mid year, I will be abandoning my students.”

An SLP on r/slp. Some version of this shows up in about eleven of the threads we read.

What ASHA counts as abandonment

Stopping services without arranging for alternative care by an appropriately qualified professional.

ASHA, Issues in Ethics: Client Abandonment

What the same guidance also says

- ✓ Leaving for a career move **isn't unethical** in itself.
- ✓ You **don't have to stay** until a replacement is hired.
- ✓ The **effort you put into the handoff** matters more than the number of weeks.
- ✓ Employers are expected to **cooperate** with a clinician who's leaving.

YOUR ROLE GETS FILLED

13,300

SLP openings a year on average through 2034, with employment growing 15%.

Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook

How to leave a caseload well

1. Check your **contract window** or notice period.
2. Give **notice early**, employer first.
3. **Finish** every report, note and bill.
4. Write a **handoff for each client**.
5. Leave **records and materials** where they belong.
6. **Stay present** through the notice period.

When a colleague says you're making the shortage worse

TRY

You

The shortage is about caseloads and pay, and I can't fix that by burning out. I'm leaving with a full handoff, and I hope they fill the role fast.

The guilt is real. It mostly tells you how much you cared.

Am I abandoning my patients if I leave SLP?

The full guide is free on slptransitions.com. Link in bio.

Send this to someone who needs it.